

Am I Late?

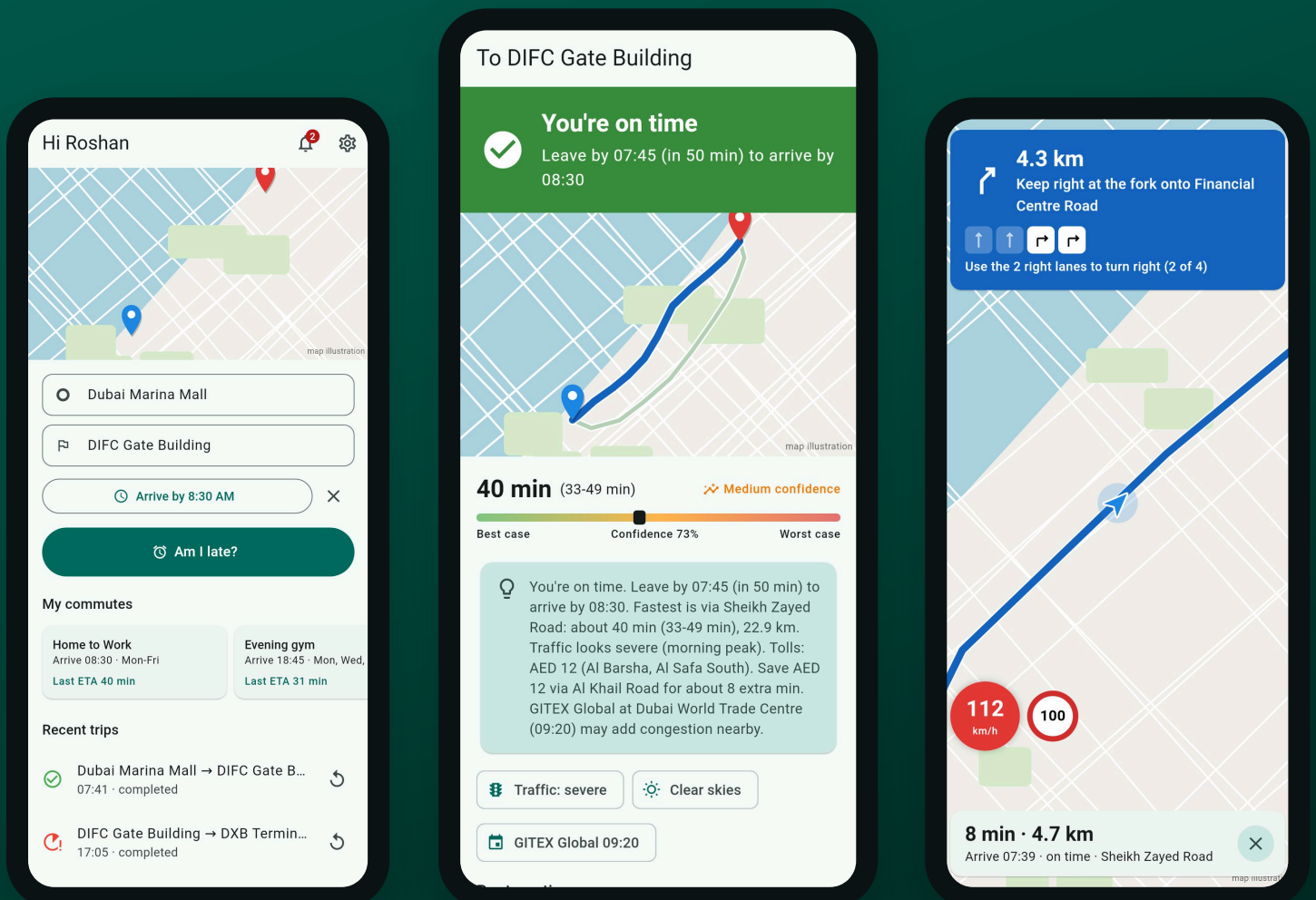
by Roshan

Your UAE commute assistant. It tells you whether you're late, when to leave, which road to take, and what it will cost in Salik and DARB, then guides you there safely.

Dubai · Abu Dhabi · Sharjah · Northern Emirates

Android & iOS

Free to run



What the app does

Enter where you're going and when you need to be there. The app checks the roads, the time of day, the weather, events and tolls, then gives you one clear answer and the best way to get there.



Am I late?

A verdict (on time, leave now, or late by N minutes), the exact time to leave and your expected arrival.



Three route choices

Fastest, cheapest (fewest tolls) and low-stress, side by side with time, distance, tolls and stress level.



Salik & DARB costs

Toll gates on each route, priced for the time you'll pass them, including peak and off-peak rates.



Honest ETAs

A best-to-worst-case range and a confidence score, not just one number.



Turn-by-turn navigation

Next turn, lane guidance, your speed against the limit, and automatic re-routing.



Fatigue warnings

Watches drive time and driving smoothness, and tells you when to take a break.



Commute alerts

Saved commutes are re-checked every 5 minutes. You're warned when traffic gets worse and when it's time to leave.



Ask Roshan

A chat assistant for "When should I leave?", "How much Salik?", "Is parking free now?" and more.



Parking

Parking tariff at your destination right now and the closest car parks.



Your data, your call

Export everything the app stores about you, or delete your account in one tap.

In this guide

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- 2 Planning a trip
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Signing in

Your account keeps your commutes, trip history and alert settings in sync. It's free and only needs an email address.

Create an account

- 1 Tap **New here? Create a free account.**
- 2 Enter your name (optional), email and a password of at least 8 characters.
- 3 Tap **Create free account.** You'll land on the home screen, signed in.

Sign in on another phone

Use the same email and password. Your commutes and settings come with you.

Server address

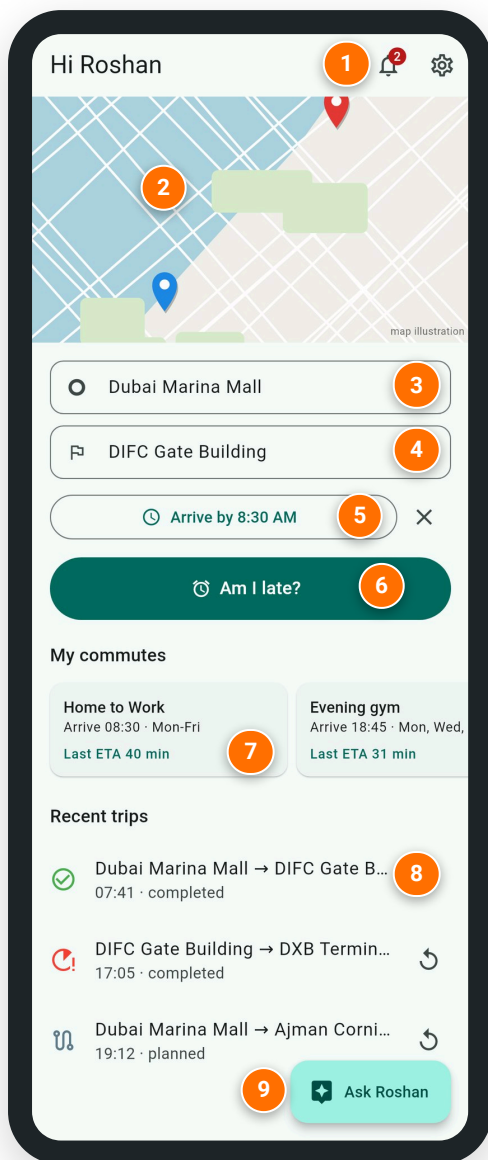
The small **Server** link at the bottom shows which Am I Late? server the app talks to. You only need to change it if you run your own server, for example `http://192.168.1.10:3000` on your home Wi-Fi. You can also change it later in Settings.

Your privacy: the app identifies you only through your sign-in. Speed samples it shares to improve traffic predictions are stored without your name or account.

Stayed signed in? The app keeps you signed in for 30 days. If you're signed out, just sign in again.

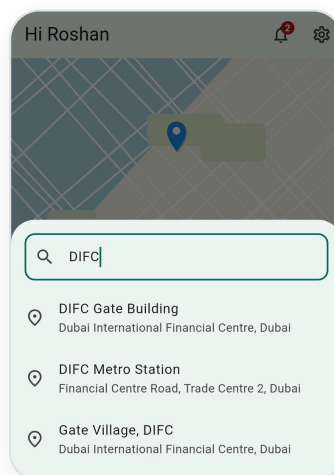
Sign-in screen

Planning a trip



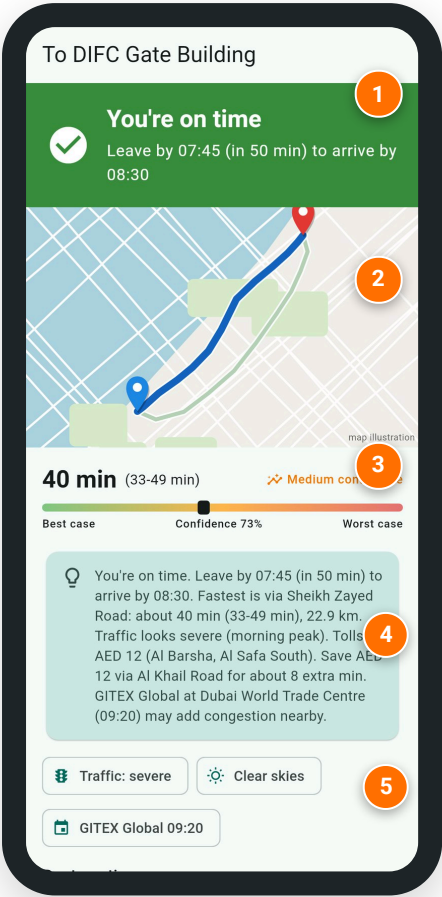
Home, ready to check a morning trip

- 1 **Alerts bell.** The red badge counts unread alerts. Tap it to open your alert inbox and settings.
- 2 **Map.** Shows your start (blue pin) and destination (red pin). **Long-press anywhere** to drop your destination there.
- 3 **Starting from.** Filled in with your current location automatically. Tap to search for another start point.
- 4 **Where to?** Tap and type a place, area, mall or landmark (see the search screen on the right).
- 5 **Arrive by** (optional). Set the time you must be there. Without it, the app tells you how long the trip takes if you leave now. Tap × to clear it.
- 6 **Am I late?** Gets your answer. The button reads *How long will it take?* when no arrival time is set.
- 7 **My commutes.** One tap checks a saved commute for its next arrival time, e.g. *Home to Work, arrive 08:30*. Shows the last ETA.
- 8 **Recent trips.** The icon shows how each trip went (✓ on time, red = late). Tap the arrow to plan it again.
- 9 **Ask Roshan.** Opens the chat assistant (section 8).

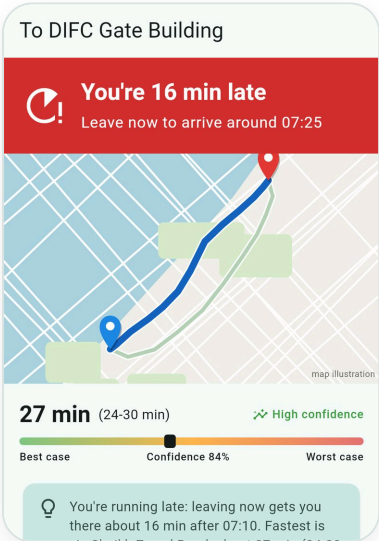


Place search. Results come from OpenStreetMap, limited to the UAE, plus built-in landmarks such as Dubai Mall, DXB and Yas Mall. **Use my current location** appears when choosing a start point.

The answer: your verdict



"You're on time": leave by 07:45 for 08:30



- 1 **Verdict banner.** The one-line answer and exactly when to leave.
- 2 **Map** of all route options; the selected one is bold.
- 3 **ETA and confidence.** The expected time (40 min), the likely range (33–49 min) and how sure the app is. The marker shows where the estimate sits between the best and worst case.
- 4 **Explanation.** Plain-language reasons: traffic level, tolls, cheaper alternatives, weather, events, school zones.
- 5 **Conditions.** Traffic level, weather and nearby events at a glance.

The four verdicts

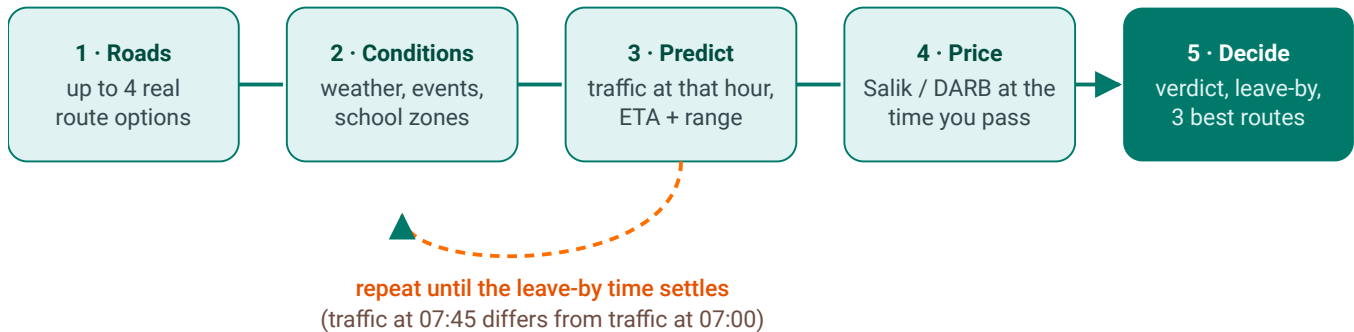
Banner	Meaning
You're on time	You have time. The banner shows the latest time to leave and how many minutes until then.
Leave now	Your ideal departure is within the next 5 minutes.
You're N min late	Even leaving right now, you'll arrive N minutes after your target. The banner shows your realistic arrival time.
Arrive around...	No arrival time was set; this is when you'll get there if you leave now.

When you're running late

Here the target was 07:10 and it's 06:55. Leaving now still means arriving about 16 minutes late, so the banner turns red and shows your realistic arrival (07:25). Use it to warn whoever is waiting for you, or tap **Start** to go straight away.

How the answer is worked out

Every "Am I late?" check runs the same five steps in a couple of seconds.



Leave-by time

= arrival target – (expected trip time + the larger of your safety buffer or half the "worst case" margin)

Example: 08:30 – (40 min + max(5 min, $\frac{1}{2} \times 9$ min)) = 07:45, ready to absorb a slower-than-usual morning.

What the traffic prediction knows

- UAE rush hours: weekday mornings (peak ~07:45) and evenings (~18:00), school pick-up, Friday's short day, and quieter Saturday/Sunday mornings.
- Commuter corridors: Sharjah/Ajman → Dubai mornings and the reverse in the evening are rated much busier.
- Live speeds reported anonymously by other drivers nearby, when available.

What slows a trip down

- **Weather:** rain (+20% or more), fog (up to +45% in very low visibility), dust and sandstorms.
- **Events:** big crowds arriving or leaving venues like Dubai World Trade Centre, Coca-Cola Arena, Etihad Arena or Expo City.
- **School zones** active during drop-off and pick-up on school days.

The more uncertain the conditions (heavy traffic, bad weather, big events), the wider the ETA range and the lower the confidence score, and the earlier the app tells you to leave.

Comparing routes, tolls & parking

Route options

Fastest Your pick **40 min**

via Sheikh Zayed Road

22.9 km AED 12 Moderate

Al Barsha (Salik AED 6) · Al Safa South (Salik AED 6)

Cheapest **47 min**

via Al Khail Road

25.4 km No tolls Moderate

Low stress **47 min**

via Al Khail Road (same road as cheapest)

25.4 km No tolls Moderate

P **Parking at destination**

Peak-hour Parkin tariff: ~AED 4/h standard, AED 6/h premium

- Gate Village Car Park (140 m)
- DIFC Central Car Park (260 m)
- Emirates Towers Parking (410 m)

Route options and parking at the destination

Scroll down on the result screen to see three route cards. **Tap a card** to select it; the map, ETA and start button update. Your preferred type (set in Settings) is marked **Your pick**.

Card	Chosen for
Fastest	Shortest expected trip time.
Cheapest	Lowest total toll cost; ties go to the faster road.
Low stress	Least congestion, fewest turns and school zones.

Each card shows time, distance, tolls and a stress rating (Relaxed, Moderate, Stressful, Very stressful), plus every toll gate and its price. When two categories pick the same road, the card says (*same road as cheapest*).

Toll rules the app applies

System	Price per gate
Salik (Dubai, 10 gates)	Mon–Sat: AED 6 at peak (06–10, 16–20), AED 4 off-peak, free 01–06 . Sunday & holidays: AED 4 (free 01–06). Al Mamzar North+South and Al Safa+Al Safa South count once.
DARB (Abu Dhabi, 4 bridges)	Mon–Sat 07–09 & 17–19: AED 4; otherwise free. Sundays & holidays free. Max AED 16 per day.

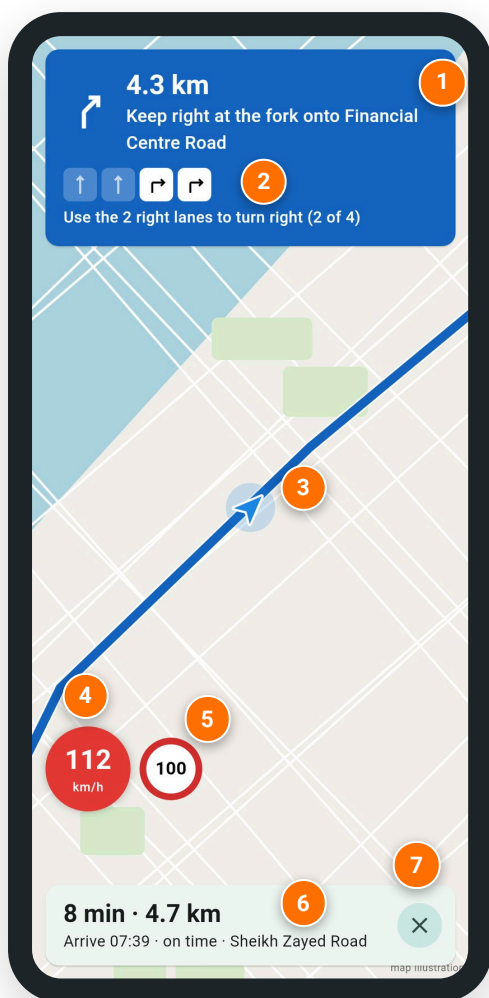
Each gate is priced for the moment you'll actually reach it, so a trip that starts at 09:50 may pass a gate after 10:00 at the off-peak rate.

Parking at the destination

Shows whether public parking is paid right now and the hourly rate (Dubai Parkin peak/off-peak, Abu Dhabi Mawaqif, Sharjah), plus the three nearest car parks.

Money-saving tip: in the example, the Al Khail Road route saves AED 12 each way for about 8 extra minutes, which adds up to roughly AED 500 a month on a weekday commute.

Navigation



Heading for the DIFC exit on Sheikh Zayed Road

Tap **Start ... route** on the result screen. The app follows your GPS position and keeps the map centred on you.

- 1 **Next maneuver:** distance to it and what to do.
- 2 **Lane guidance:** white lanes are the ones to use, with a written hint, e.g. "Use the 2 right lanes to turn right (2 of 4)". Shown when the road data includes lanes.
- 3 **You** (blue arrow) on your route. Tap the map to look around; a button appears to re-centre.
- 4 **Your speed.** Normal colour below the limit, **amber** just above it, **red** when you're over your tolerance (e.g. 112 in a 100 zone).
- 5 **Speed limit** for the road you're on.
- 6 **Time and distance left**, arrival time, and whether you're still on time for your target.
- 7 **End trip.** Asks for confirmation first.

Working in the background

- **Off route?** More than ~80 m from the route, the app finds a new way from where you are.
- **Traffic changed?** Every 3 minutes it re-checks. If the fastest route now saves 3+ minutes, you get a **Switch** button; if you'll now be late, a banner tells you.
- **Speed alerts** are sent if you go over the limit plus your tolerance.
- **Helping others:** about once a minute your speed is shared anonymously so everyone's predictions improve.
- **Arrival:** within ~60 m of the destination the trip completes and tells you whether you made it on time.

Keep your eyes on the road: mount your phone before starting, and use the Ask Roshan assistant only when parked.

Fatigue warnings

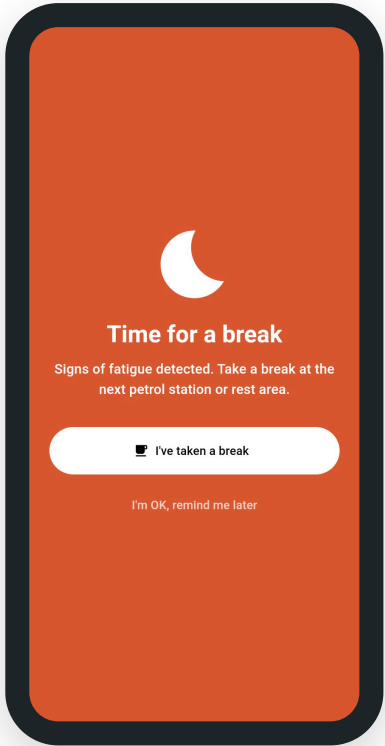
While navigating, the app estimates how tired you might be every 2 minutes, using:

- **Time behind the wheel** since your last break.
- **Time of day:** risk is highest 02:00–06:00 and in the 14:00–16:00 afternoon dip.
- **Steering smoothness** (weaving and over-correcting) and **harsh braking or swerving**, from the phone's motion sensors.

When the score is high, or you pass your **Break reminder** time (default 2 hours), a full-screen alert appears with vibration and a sound.

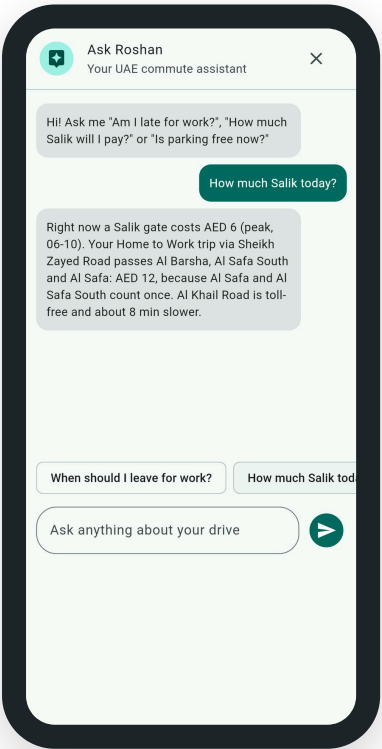
- **I've taken a break** resets the drive timer.
- **I'm OK, remind me later** snoozes it for 15 minutes.

Sensor readings are processed on your phone. Only summary numbers (such as "steering variance") are sent for scoring, never raw sensor data. You can turn monitoring off in Settings.



Fatigue alert

Ask Roshan



Asking about Salik

Tap **Ask Roshan** on the home screen. Type a question or tap a suggestion. The assistant looks at your saved commutes, a fresh plan for your next commute, your location and today's toll prices before answering.

Try asking	You get
"Am I late for work?" / "When should I leave?"	The full verdict for your next commute.
"How much Salik today?"	Current Salik & DARB prices and your commute's toll total.
"Is parking free now?"	The tariff where you are, or at your commute destination.
"What's the weather?"	Conditions and visibility for your drive.
"I'm sleepy"	Safe-break advice.

By default the assistant answers with built-in rules for free. If your server has a Claude API key configured, it answers in natural language from the same facts.

Saved commutes

Save the trips you make regularly and the app watches them for you, so you don't need to open it every morning.

Add a commute

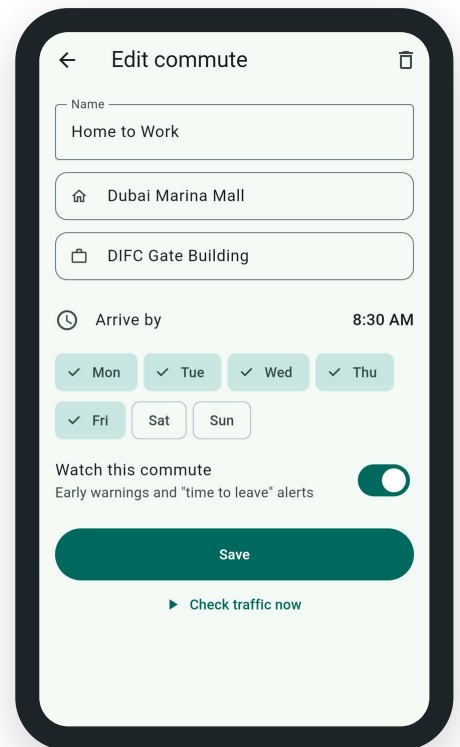
- 1 Open **Settings** → **My commutes** → **Add a commute** (or tap the "Get time to leave alerts" card on the home screen).
- 2 Give it a **name**, such as *Home to Work*.
- 3 Choose **From** and **To** (search, or use your current location).
- 4 Set the **Arrive by** time and the **days** it applies (Mon–Fri by default).
- 5 Keep **Watch this commute** on and tap **Save**.

What happens next

From 3 hours before your arrival time on those days, the server re-plans the commute **every 5 minutes**:

- **Traffic worsened:** if the trip gets slower by your threshold (default 10 min) since the last check. At most one every 30 minutes.
- **Time to leave:** once a day, about 10 minutes before you should set off (or "You're running late" if it's already too late).

Check traffic now (when editing a commute) runs the check straight away. The trash icon deletes the commute. Home-screen commute cards plan the trip for its next arrival time with one tap.

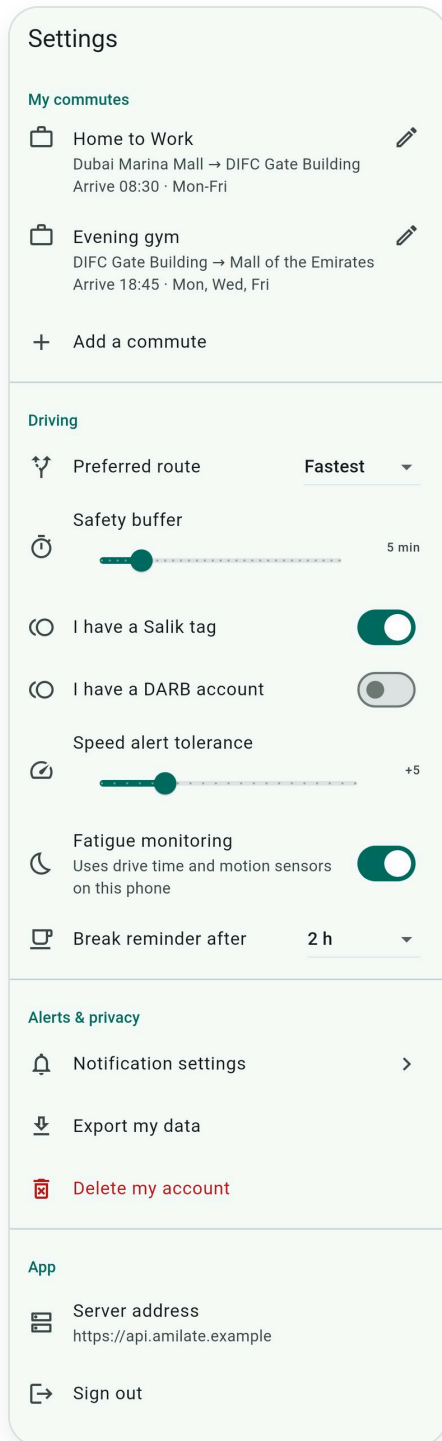


Editing a commute

Recent alerts inbox

- **In-app alerts** (always available): delivered instantly while the app is open or running in the background, and kept in the inbox.
- **Push notifications** (when the server has Firebase set up): also arrive when the app is closed. The status line at the bottom of the settings tells you which mode you have.

Settings reference



Settings (gear icon on home)

Option	What it does
My commutes	Your saved commutes; tap to edit, or add a new one (section 9).
Preferred route	Fastest, Cheapest or Low stress. Pre-selected on results and used for commute alerts.
Safety buffer	0–30 min of extra time built into every leave-by time (default 5). Increase it if lateness is costly.
I have a Salik tag / DARB account	Records which toll accounts you use.
Speed alert tolerance	How far over the limit (0–20 km/h) before the speed turns red and a "Slow down" alert is sent.
Fatigue monitoring	Turns drive-time and motion-sensor monitoring on or off.
Break reminder after	1–4 hours of continuous driving before a break reminder.
Notification settings	Alert types, threshold, quiet hours and inbox (section 10).
Export my data	Copies everything stored about you (account, commutes, trips, alerts) to the clipboard as a JSON file you can save.
Delete my account	Permanently removes your account and all its data after you confirm.
Server address	Which Am I Late? server the app uses.
Sign out	Signs you out of this phone.

Changes save instantly; there's no Save button on this screen.

Privacy, costs & FAQ

Permissions the app asks for

Permission	Why
Location (while using)	Your start point, navigation, speed and speed limit.
Notifications	Commute, speed and fatigue alerts.
Motion sensors (iOS)	Fatigue detection during navigation.

What it costs

The app runs on free services by default: OpenStreetMap for roads, place search and speed limits, and Open-Meteo for weather. Whoever runs the server can optionally add Google or Mapbox routing (live-traffic trip times), Firebase push notifications and a Claude-powered assistant.

Frequently asked questions

The map area is blank or grey.

The app build needs a (free) Google Maps key. Everything else still works: verdicts, routes, tolls and navigation instructions.

My result says "Estimated route (offline)".

The server couldn't reach the road-routing service, so it estimated from straight-line distance. Times are rough; try again shortly.

Why did it tell me to leave earlier than usual?

Heavier predicted traffic, bad weather, a nearby event or an active school zone. The explanation box names the reason.

Are the toll prices exact?

They follow the published Salik and DARB rules, priced for when you pass each gate. Public holidays and special-event pricing may differ, and gate positions are approximate.

I didn't get a commute alert.

Check that the commute is switched on, today is one of its days, you're within 3 hours of its arrival time, it's outside your quiet hours, and the alert type is on. Without push notifications, the app needs to be open or in the background.

How accurate are the ETAs?

Predictions use UAE traffic patterns, time of day, weather and live reports from other drivers. The range and confidence score show how certain each estimate is; they improve as more people use the app.

About this guide. Screenshots were rendered from the app's real screens with a sample Monday-morning commute (Dubai Marina Mall to DIFC, arrive 08:30). The map areas are simplified illustrations drawn from the real route data; in the app you'll see Google Maps. School zones in a fresh install are sample data until official zones are loaded.